

GDP / GMP Records — Review Reference

Purpose: Field-by-field reference for reviewing Good Distribution Practice (GDP) and Good Manufacturing Practice (GMP) records that accompany pharmaceutical shipments. Original summary built

from EU GDP Guidelines (2013/C 343/01), FDA 21 CFR Parts 210/211, WHO TRS 961 Annex 9, and Cold Chain 4.0 digital-record practice. Not a copy of any proprietary SOP.

Governing standard (see [standards-of-precedence.md](#), section 2)

Product label storage condition (floor) > destination-country GDP/GMP > IATA CEIV Pharma / TCR for the air leg > WHO TRS 961 / USP <1079> supporting practice > customer quality agreement if stricter.

The narrowest temperature range and strictest documentation/retention requirement win.

Records that should accompany or back a GDP/GMP shipment

- Product name, strength, dosage form
- Batch / lot number
- Expiry date (and retest date if applicable)
- Quantity shipped
- Storage condition on the label (e.g. “Store at 2–8 °C”, “Do not freeze”, “Store below 25 °C”)
- Manufacturer / MAH (marketing authorization holder) and distributor
- Wholesale distribution authorization / license number (GDP)
- Certificate of Analysis reference (see [../02-certificate-of-analysis/](#))
- Temperature log / data-logger record for the lane (see [cold-chain/02-temperature-control/](#))
- Chain-of-custody / handover signatures

Core GDP review points

- [] Storage condition on the record matches the product label exactly (never widened)
- [] Batch/lot number on the record matches the CoA and the physical labels
- [] Expiry date present and not expired / not expiring inside the transit + shelf window
- [] Distributor holds a valid wholesale distribution authorization
- [] Temperature was continuously monitored for the whole lane, logger calibration current
- [] Any excursion has a documented investigation and a product disposition decision
- [] Falsified-medicines safety features intact where required (tamper-evidence, serialization)
- [] Retention period for the record documented and met (GDP typically ≥ 5 years; confirm locally)

Core GMP review points (where a batch record / release doc is in scope)

- [] Batch record signed by the authorized/qualified person (QP for EU)
- [] In-process and finished-product test results present and within specification
- [] Deviations and CAPAs referenced and closed
- [] Labeling and packaging reconciliation complete

Cold Chain 4.0 / digital-record points

- [] Data-logger file (not just a summary) archived and traceable to the shipment
- [] Logger ID and calibration certificate reference on the record
- [] No time gaps in the digital time-series; alarms acknowledged
- [] Digital record immutable / audit-trailed (who changed what, when)

Common findings

-  Storage condition on paperwork is wider than the product label (e.g. label says 2–8 °C, record says “ambient”) — Critical.
-  Temperature excursion with no investigation or disposition — Critical.
-  Expired lot, or expiry before delivery + minimum shelf life — Critical.
-  Logger calibration certificate expired at ship date — Major.
-  Batch number mismatch between CoA and shipping record — Major.
-  Missing retention-period notation — Minor.

Sources

- EU GDP Guidelines 2013/C 343/01: https://health.ec.europa.eu/medicinal-products/good-manufacturing-practice-and-good-distribution-practice_en
- FDA 21 CFR Parts 210 & 211: <https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-21/chapter-I/subchapter-C/part-211>
- WHO TRS 961 Annex 9 (storage & distribution): <https://www.who.int/publications/m/item/annex-9-trs-961>
- USP <1079> Good Storage and Distribution Practices.